



Hammered and **STRICKEN**

Nothing has hurt the CPI(M) more in the state as its handling of the Lalgarh siege and the Maoists. For the Left, the time to learn from their mistakes seems to be long over.

By Abhijit Dasgupta

History often remembers certain years as landmarks. One such turning point for West Bengal was in 1977 when the CPI(M)-led Left Front came to power. Thirty-two years on, 2009 may well be remembered as the year that saw the beginning of the end of three decades of the Leftist stranglehold on the state.

The Leftists' dreams of forming a government at the Centre lie shattered, industrialisation is a bubble that burst with Nandigram and Singur and its

The CPI(M) is going from